Incident handler's journal

Date: 8.9.2025	**Entry:** 1
Description	Investigated a ransomware incident initiated via a phishing attachment at a healthcare clinic. Reviewed headers, user report, and logs to confirm deployment and file encryption. This falls under *Detection and Analysis* from the NIST Incident Response Lifecycle.
Tool(s) used	E-mail
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Group of unethical hackers ● **What** happened? A phishing email that contained a malicious attachment was sent. Once it was downloaded, ransomware was deployed, encrypting the organization's computer files. ● **When** did the incident occur? Tuesday at 9:00 a.m. ● **Where** did the incident happen? U.S. health care clinic ● **Why** did the incident happen? The group is demanding funds.
Additional notes	It’s a typical case of Ransom. The group is demanding money in exchange for encrypted information that’s contained on the computer. Should the company pay?

Date: 9.9.2025	**Entry:** 2
Description	Analyzed a suspicious email attachment with VirusTotal, correlated the file hash with engine verdicts. This falls under *Detection and Analysis* from the NIST Incident Response Lifecycle.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Malicious attacker ● **What** happened? An employee received an e-mail that contained a malicious attachment, upon downloading the attachment and opening it, a malicious payload was executed on the computer. ● **When** did the incident occur? At 1:11 PM. ● **Where** did the incident happen? At the organization. ● **Why** did the incident happen? Attacker is trying to obtain sensitive information.
Additional notes	Using the file hash, it was determined that the file is malicious. What was the file trying to obtain? What is the mechanism it uses to obtain sensitive information?

Date: 10.09.2025	**Entry:** 3
Description	Analyzing packets.
Tool(s) used	Wireshark

The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Not applicable. ● **What** happened? Not applicable. ● **When** did the incident occur? Not applicable. ● **Where** did the incident happen? Not applicable. ● **Why** did the incident happen? Not applicable.
Additional notes	In this activity, I analyzed the packet capture file (.pcap) using Wireshark. I explored how to examine the various protocols and data layers inside a network packet. Additionally, I applied filters to select and inspect packets based on specific criteria.

Date: 10.09.2025.	**Entry:** 4
Description	Capturing packets.
Tool(s) used	tcpdump
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Not applicable. ● **What** happened? Not applicable. ● **When** did the incident occur? Not applicable. ● **Where** did the incident happen? Not applicable. ● **Why** did the incident happen? Not applicable.
Additional notes	In this activity, I used tcpdump to identify available network interfaces, capture live network traffic, save network traffic to a file, and filter the packet capture data.

Date: 10.09.2025	**Entry:** 5
Description	Exploring signatures and logs
Tool(s) used	Suricata
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Not applicable. ● **What** happened? Not applicable. ● **When** did the incident occur? Not applicable. ● **Where** did the incident happen? Not applicable. ● **Why** did the incident happen? Not applicable.
Additional notes	In this activity, I ran Suricata with a custom rule to trigger it, and examined the output logs.

Date: 12.09.2025	**Entry:** 6
Description	Performing a Query with Wazuh.

Tool(s) used	Wazuh
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. ● **Who** caused the incident? Not applicable. ● **What** happened? Not applicable. ● **When** did the incident occur? Not applicable. ● **Where** did the incident happen? Not applicable. ● **Why** did the incident happen? Not applicable.
Additional notes	In this activity, I performed a search in Wazuh for any failed SSH logins for the root account.

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1. Reflections/Notes: Were there any specific activities that were challenging for you? Why or why not?

The most challenging one for me was learning how to set up Wazuh properly. I had difficulties setting up the shared folder in my OracleBox VM. I initially installed the OVA from the website, but couldn't get it to recognize the shared folder. After that, I installed Ubuntu and set up Wazuh on my own.

2. Has your understanding of incident detection and response changed since taking this course?
   Yes, definitely! I had no prior experience, and learning all the steps in the NIST detection and response lifecycle and how they overlap was an exciting journey. Understanding how the phases connect in practice—such as how accurate detection directly informs containment—helped me see the lifecycle as a continuous, real-world process rather than isolated steps.

3. Was there a specific tool or concept that you enjoyed the most? Why?

   The tool I enjoyed the most was Wireshark. It was exciting to see that the knowledge I gained could be applied practically, allowing me to analyze live network traffic and better understand incident detection.